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US equities rally on tech strength, oil slides

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The **S&P 500** closed at 7,690.73, up +0.41%, while the **Nasdaq 100** jumped +1.17% to 29,529.35. Tech giants led the advance, offsetting a modest dip in the **Dow Jones** (-0.07%).

Energy prices fell sharply, with WTI crude down -4.60% to 98.89, dragging the energy ETF **XLE** lower. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to 5.14, supporting the dollar and pressuring commodities.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,690.73	+0.41%	
Dow Jones	51,966.03	-0.07%	
Nasdaq 100	29,529.35	+1.17%	
Russell 2000	2,728.30	+0.25%	
VIX	18.44	-7.75%	
10Y Yield	5.14	+0.75%	
WTI Crude	98.89	-4.60%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AMZN	262.45	+4.98%
TSLA	368.06	+3.76%
NVDA	217.09	+1.38%
MSFT	533.52	+0.84%
GOOGL	344.18	+1.05%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	`AMZN`
Quarterly Revenue	149.2 bn
YoY Growth	+12.4%
EPS	2.31
Guidance	Revenue +9% YoY, EPS +7%

Amazon beat top-line expectations, driven by a 15% surge in international sales and continued strength in AWS. The upbeat guidance lifted sentiment across consumer-discretionary and cloud-software stocks.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%–5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year yield: 5.14, up +0.75%
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core PCE 04:30, Initial Jobless Claims 06:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s export data due Friday shows a 3.2% YoY rise, supporting risk-on sentiment.
- Eurozone manufacturing PMI slipped to 44.8, keeping the euro under pressure.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:30 Oct 21	`META`	Ad revenue trend, AI spend
04:00 Oct 21	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan growth
05:30 Oct 21	`AVGO`	Chip demand, margin outlook
07:00 Oct 21	`XOM`	Production guidance, price assumptions

Stocks worth watching

- `NVDA` – AI chip demand accelerating, revenue guidance above consensus.
- `XLF` – Banking earnings mixed; watch for Fed-rate impact on net interest margins.
- `XLE` – Crude price pullback may create buying opportunities on dip.
- `XLK` – Tech rally continues; monitor semiconductor inventory data.
- `GS` – Fixed-income trading volumes rising, could boost profit.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could force another rate hike.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East reigniting oil-supply concerns.
- Weak earnings from major banks, especially `JPM` or `GS`.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected consumer-spending data bolstering retail earnings.
- Continued strength in AI-related revenues, lifting `NVDA` and `MSFT`.
- Further decline in the VIX below 17, indicating reduced volatility.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Earnings Filings

Trading Economics — CPI

EIA — Crude Oil Prices